LESSON 3.1 | Lesson notes

Passing by Pointer

Overview

C passes arguments by value, so a function normally changes only its own copy. To let a function change the caller's variable, pass its address and have the function dereference it. void addOne(int *n) { *n = *n + 1; } called as addOne(ampersand x) really changes x. The same idea lets a function return several results through pointer parameters, and avoids copying large structures. Mark the parameter const, for example const int *p, when the function only reads the data.

Key points

- Part of: Pointers and Functions
- About 15 minutes
- Try the example yourself, then check it

How to use this handout

1. Read the overview first, then work through the key points in order.
2. Write down anything you are unsure about and ask in the course forum.
3. Use page 2 to plan your practice and keep notes.

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Practice checklist

- [ ] Read: Passing by Pointer
- [ ] Try the example from the lesson
- [ ] Explain the main idea in your own words
- [ ] Answer the related questions
- [ ] Ask about anything unclear in the forum

My notes